

MADISON: Okay. Okay, do you want to try to press play then?

LISA: Yes.

MADISON: Okay. When was the last time you watched this? Did you watch it when you were putting all of these in Drive?

LISA: Just the beginning of it, and I was shocked by how southern my accent was.

MADISON: Okay.

LISA: But I have not watched the whole thing, no. Okay.

MADISON: Oh, there's Stumpy sneezing. Okay. Okay, you have it pulled up? Yep. Okay. I'll count us down and then after one, let's press play.

LISA:

Okay.

MADISON:

I think it's fine if it's not perfectly synced, it's just so I can see what you're describing.

LISA:

Okay, sorry. Okay.

MADISON:

And I'm not going to play audio on my end, so.

LISA:

Oh, okay. Okay. I can turn mine up a little. Okay.

MADISON:

Okay. Three, two, one. So do you want to start describing it? Or you could say like the date.

LISA:

Yeah. So this is April 12th, 1997. It says 9:40 p.m. This is in Oxford, North Carolina, where your dad and I were living out on a 57 acre farm. And we've been waiting for this mare to have her baby. Put your light off, Kevin. I'm bossing him around because I'm using an old, old timey video recorder and The light was making my zoom, my focus. Only, or I did. Have her baby. So that's the option. And it's night. We haven't swore she was going to have one light. I got the time on it. So we went. Ironically, to a Humane Society auction. And she wasn't doing anything. Actually, I actually left the auction to come see her. Got a pretty little star on the face. Your job is very excited about this fall. It looks really light in the back.

MADISON:

Because he wanted him to be a buckskin, right?

LISA:

Yeah, he wanted him to be a buckskin. Oh. But he ended up, and I don't, I can't remember this video if we can tell how bad his leg is, but he had a deformed leg in the front. We ended up taking him to NC State vet school and they casted him, put him in a cast while that leg grew. Like when I was drying him, when you ran in the house. I dried him really good. She listened to his lungs. I don't know. Sounded really congested. She was chewing on his angel feet. Oh, I love their angel feet, that little membrane on their feet. Let me ask you something. We got out of the car and tried to get up. And I wanted to make sure I didn't know how long she's been on labor. So I checked to make sure she wasn't strained and she had like two more contractions and it was out. So she was trying to get up. No, she didn't know contractions. She was trying to see what's going on probably. She already had half the fallout over. So I said she had half the fallout when we pulled up, pulled in. Oh my goodness. Missed by 5 minutes.

MADISON:

Do you remember because you start saying in the video you really wanted to see her full? Do you remember? Yeah.

LISA:

Yeah. I had never seen one before.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

We missed it by five minutes, he said. We left at 8:30 and then I started the video at 9:40 p.m. So, Chloe's the best mare, though. She really was the best horse. Again, but where's my... You can see her placenta hanging. Oh, I don't think I saw her.

MADISON:

Why was she a good mare?

LISA:

Say what?

MADISON:

Why was she a good mare?

LISA:

Oh, just a very, very kind, very sweet, calm. I'm supposed to have enough, but maybe I need to get closer. Yeah, you might. I bought this video camera for just this event.

MADISON:

Oh, I didn't know that.

LISA:

Yes. So I'm asking your dad where the Zoom is. I don't think I had ever used it.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

And I think I was so excited.

MADISON:

Oh. Is that the camera that you ended up using for like all the other videos?

LISA:

Yes. Yeah. Oh, she's not gonna step on him, is she? They get so close. They walk all around them and you know, she's not always looking down, but they, they, he told me, your dad told me they just, they know where they are. You're blocking my view, baby. Chloe. Yeah, before me, darling. Blocking my view. Pauline, I want you to know I put six. No, I'm talking about. Tell him it's OK, honey. Yeah. He's asking me to come around because it's funny I had to put. Six muddy dogs in the house without wiping their feet. Now she's got a piece of placenta on her head. Chloe does. Your dad's cleaning his umbilical cord right now. Doesn't sound congested to you, does he? Because those can get infected. That's really bad.

MADISON:

But it's already cut or did she like chew it?

LISA:

Yeah, a lot of times it just detaches when the mirror spins around. They don't, they don't have to cut them usually. It's just nature. Oh, this is much clearer. He's so cute. It's okay. All that matters is that you had a healthy baby. My southern accent. Being a nurse. The medicine bag, the bag with the umbilical tape and the... I even had a, I had a bag ready for this delivery.

MADISON:

She's eating the towel or something.

LISA:

Yeah, she grabbed the towel. I would sit down for the baby because it was laying in mud, but I guess it really doesn't matter, does it? You can tell I grew up in the city. I don't know much. Okay, she dropped it. That was her placenta. You you have to time that like you need to know how long it took her to drop. Because if it takes a while, it could mean that she's retained part of the placenta. I can't believe I missed it. We pulled right up. You can see my car over there. Oh yeah, I still have the headlights on. I bet the car still running. There's something going around. I was just getting in the car. But I hope she didn't have it tonight. Kevin said she always delivers in the morning. He thought she would deliver Sunday morning. And we checked her. Kevin got up last night and checked her and I checked her the night before and I took Friday off and. Here is Saturday night. Oh, he does that. He's getting an enema. Did you do it? Did you do it? Yeah. OK. See how that front leg is bending? Yeah, that's that's not good.

MADISON:

Yeah, but that's. Um, what's very interesting to me about this video or thinking about it is I don't think dad can. I don't think he sees the injury or will even like accept that he's injured. Like subconsciously. Yeah, it's not until the end of the video. I think, yeah.

LISA:

It's all the air around his face. Ugh. Now that I see it bending, it just makes me cringe. You've never seen that before. Poor guy. Yeah, I did. Look, he's got a little goatee. Did he hurt himself? That's not the bin where she broke a log.

MADISON:

Because at first, you know, it's normal for foals to stumble like that, right? So...

LISA:

Oh, yes.

MADISON:

There's not very concerning, but it's like... They're supposed to get up in like the first 30 minutes, right?

LISA:

I think they have to nurse in the first hour. I honestly did not know that leg was deformed at the time. I thought it was just normal, but now that I'm looking at it, you can see how much... how much thicker that joint is. Yeah, yeah, you can... Listen, this horse, we took him to NC State. They casted him while he grew. We had to take him back when the cast got too small. I think we did it three or four times, Madison. Just because I'll never see another horse have a baby. When I

took Friday off. Can you imagine being out here right now with five dogs, 6 dogs? Again, with all the dogs, Sydney saw something was going on. She started barking.

MADISON:

Sydney.

LISA:

Sydney ended up being we. We took Sydney from Uncle Tony. She was a Blue Heeler.

MADISON:

Yeah. OK, but what about?

LISA:

Oh, the leg? We took him, yes. We took him about three or four times, which meant that we had to take Chloe with him because she was still nursing. So it was a big ordeal. But he was never going to be a stallion or a show horse. Your dad really wanted to ride him and maybe do some showmanship with him. And but we he had. A friend in the horse world that needed a teaser horse to get the other female, the mares to ovulate. Are they normal? And he donated her. Him to her and he lived a great long life.

MADISON:

I remember you saying that.

LISA:

Yeah, and I was really happy about that because he, anybody else would probably put him down. He was, I mean, I don't want to say he was worthless, but he really is. Well, wasn't it?

MADISON:

He also had a really good temperament, right?

LISA:

Very good. Oh, so sweet. And that's one of the things she told your dad was he he was so sweet for being a stat. You know, essentially he was a stallion. He wasn't gilded and I just want to make sure he. And and she had a nurse mare operation Madison, so it was really important that she kept her mares. Having babies so then. if they needed to nurse a fall where it's mom died or couldn't nurse. And that's a really important operation to have. I think this is maybe when your dad's realizing his leg, you know, he's not going to get up.

MADISON:

Yeah, yeah, because now it's 9:55.

LISA:

Yeah.

MADISON:

And it was like, what, 9:08 when you started recording?

LISA:

Yeah. No, I think it was 9:40. Oh. You'll have to check that, but...

MADISON:

I think it was maybe 9:08, 'cause it's not continuous. There have been jumps, I think, where you hosted and then started to play again.

LISA:

Okay. He's pulling you down. Wait a minute, I don't want to call you, I don't think you want to pick him up on the video.

MADISON:

They're like zooming in on something.

LISA:

On the field next to you. Was it Superstar we were talking about?

MADISON:

Yeah. And Superstar was Carla's horse, right?

LISA:

Yes. Yes. You haven't told the story. You put Chloe in here, what, a week ago? Three weeks ago. Was it three weeks? No. Two weeks. Two weeks ago. What'd she do? She didn't wag her. She bagged up really big. And then Kevin moved over here. And she fed. She fed up now?

MADISON:

Yeah, now I think he's starting to...

LISA:

Yeah, because he's pulling the legs out. But her bag shrunk up.

MADISON:

What do you mean her bag shrunk up, like the belly?

LISA:

Yeah, so their bag is the bag of milk.

MADISON:

Oh, okay.

LISA:

That the teeth are, you know, connected to and they they get it gets full. right before they fall. So she had bagged up and then it shrunk, so she kind of gave us a false start there. And then waxing up is when the actual teats will get a little wax on them. Well, I wouldn't think I came home and saw this part at least. and they'll then they'll start dripping and when they're dripping they'll then it's it's almost, you know, hours. You're hours away. I ran out there without the battery on the camera. Yelled at Kevin. No, I said it's always. Oh my gosh, we're not even married yet.

MADISON:

I know. That was also a bit of a shock. It's like you guys are kind of fighting like the whole time.

LISA:

We are. We are bickering, right?

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

But we're not angry.

MADISON:

No, you're not like fighting, but yeah, you are. You're both kind of saying things like. Yeah, that are a little pointed.

LISA:

I would have liked this thing. Oh, very much and bantering.

MADISON:

Yeah. How long were you together at this point?

LISA:

Oh, that's why I meant you should have hollered. See how bossy I am already. I was thinking get rid of the dogs so Chloe wouldn't fret. That's why I thought she was trying to stand up. We were together... I always have to do this like when when Ray Dennison was born. So it was August. I

don't see her. Of 96. And she was hearing it when we pulled up and Lisa looked at the dogs up. I think it was August of 96. And then of course you were. You're born the next year. Oh, we do. We do have the cell phones, but without pictures. Look at that old phone.

MADISON:

Yeah, it's huge.

LISA:

That was Dean. Call Ellen. It's like I've had a baby. He tried to tease me outside at the auction. When he got there, he said they drove by our house and he was saying we had a silly teasing me because I've basically been on school watch. Thank you. It's like we're having a baby. That's so funny. We moved Halloween, right on Halloween weekend. We moved of this year of '97. We moved to Midway. Kentucky and like, lived on Waterford Farm and that's where I had you. Only 10 o'clock. Oh, this clock, oh. Mine will be up. Oh, he just, he just said the clock was off. Progress anyway.

MADISON:

Is that Wayne Puckett that he was, yeah.

LISA:

Calling them. Wayne and Ellen. I don't know why they work together but right there. And there's the stall. So she must have been in the stall because I do see some...

MADISON:

I still don't think he's realized something's wrong with his leg.

LISA:

That might be part of the paddock. That might be.

MADISON:

And he just, the foal looks so tired. What was his name?

LISA:

You know, I wish I could remember that. It's not Forest because Forest was our other foal. But what did, I think we called him Buckwheat.

MADISON:

That was one of the blue healer, wasn't that Brett's? Blue Healer was.

LISA:

Yeah, that was Brett's Blue Healer. Is that one up? Oh, well, that one must be. Do you think his name is also? I do. I'm trying to hopefully say it in the video. I can't remember, but he was a bugskin. You're sure she won't step on this baby's foot? Well, what happened now? And see, he's like right up under her. No. Kevin, ooh. That made me really nervous. Step on it for a second. There she goes. She's spinning around now. Pause for wanting to be a labor and delivery nurse. Trying again this. This was really something I was looking forward to and what are you going to do?

MADISON:

Yeah, I mean, you're pretty vocal and expressive throughout it. You say how much you really wanted to see it and yeah, you keep saying how worried you are she's going to step on him.

LISA:

You know, I grew up in the city. I really had never touched a horse till I met your dad. I'm not even sure I'd seen one. I'm sure I saw one somewhere, but probably in Charlottesville when we took Julie to college, but I'd never really touched one. And, you know, all of our animals were spayed and neutered, so I'd never eaten other than a hamster. I'd never seen an animal give birth. And I really did like his horses. I didn't like riding them. I felt I didn't feel comfortable horseback riding because you're up so high and things are unpredictable and I didn't grow up riding horses. So I was always really nervous, but I really liked them as animals. As, as, and he, he had such a nice piece of property. They always had really nice pastures and a lot of area, you know, a lot of acreage to have a nice life. And this is about Oxford and Henderson. It's about an hour, hour 15 minutes to Raleigh Durham. So when I started doing clinical research, I would commute to Durham. That's what the house looks like after I do this. So I met a dog in there. He was probably up on the bed. Yay! Your dad would remember his name much better, quicker. He always remembered horses' names.

MADISON:

Not as quickly.

LISA:

He still has his angel feet on. Can you see?

MADISON:

I think I think at one point you zoom in on them. You may be about to do that in the video.

LISA:

Get me in there, baby. Yeah, I'm on the book back and I'm gonna be starting playing. Oh, really? Right, because she let me rub him and come right over and start rubbing on him right away. Of course, I've learned all of this from your father.

MADISON:

Like everything you're telling me now? Like what you're saying in the video?

LISA:

Yeah, bagging up, waxing up, the angel feet.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

Really? Is it hard? I had a medical bag ready with a, you know, with old towels and we had to use Betadine, which is like an iodine on his umbilical cords.

MADISON:

There, there's the angel feet.

LISA:

Yeah. Comes out of there. They can contact the mother in utero.

MADISON:

It's also, yeah, that shot, you can see the blood on the ground.

LISA:

Yeah. That's I can't remember. Do I show the placenta?

MADISON:

I don't think you do, but that's also it's because I remember watching this with you when you first digitized these and I forgot it was at night. So when you told me it was really dark, so I may not like the video. It's just interesting how you remember things, you know? Mm-hmm.

LISA:

He does, I say something about he looks like a donkey and he kind of does.

MADISON:

Yeah. And he just looks really like tired to me too, or kind of sad.

LISA:

They do get tired. It's a lot.

MADISON:

Like it's almost like he just decides like, okay, I'm just gonna rest now. Yeah. But he should be getting up. Yeah. So was he able to nurse on her then without being able to get up or was he able to get up on his own or he had to have the cast to get up?

LISA:

Now he gets up, you'll see, I think your dad gets him up and he's probably a good 80 to 100 pounds. But he did walk. I remember that without even watching the video he walked, but it just looked like that leg was going to break at any moment, you know. So. I would say within a week. Have a pattern working pattern here. We took him to NC State vet school where your Aunt Julie went. So that was about an hour away. In Raleigh. She had no mouth. The only thing she tried to do is bite me. Oh my god, we're still arguing. Yeah, you're gonna try to make it sound better. That's so funny. For the babies. Oh, and so then the placenta will be hanging after birth and then your dad tied it up. And what that does is when you kind of, well, he examined it and then you tie it in a knot and it just gives it more weight to naturally come off. I think you should keep that. And I'll keep seeing her. Imagine if we brought them with them. My sister, Jennifer. Oh, we named him Forrest, Madison.

MADISON:

Did you just say that in the video?

LISA:

No, I thought Forrest was Cedar, but Cedar, our other foal. Cedar is our other foal and that's the foal that Jennifer ended up taking, my sister, when we moved. But, but this is Forrest. That's right. I didn't say it in the video and now I remember we called him Forrest because when he ran he looked kind of funny and so we, that maybe one Forrest, you know, fun. And I remember singing, Run Forrest, run. Because I was so happy for him to run when we thought, you know, when we first took him to NC State, Kevin, your dad, had me completely prepared that they would tell us to put him down. And that was one of the solid options because He was, he was just, your dad used to call it a pasture ornament, meaning they're just standing in, you know, they're just standing out there in the pasture and they can't, you can't ride them, you can't bring them. So, yeah, that was forest for a minute, or more than a minute, I thought. That was the other, because we had two foals. Cedar was born another time when I wasn't living with your dad I think we were dating but this is I have I have now moved to North Carolina and was living with your dad when this happened so um and I don't know is that the end of the video?

MADISON:

Or I guess so you're just seeing the like Gray, static.

LISA:

Static, yeah.

MADISON:

I'll let it run until then, but yeah, I think that may be the end.

LISA:

Yeah. And I probably have more video of him. But there was, it was a really exciting night and I was obviously disappointed because it's the build up. anticipation, getting up, we would get up, we would take turns getting up in the middle of the night to check her and, and it was exciting for a city girl like me. I was excited about it and that was, it was truly one of those things where, um, Yeah, I don't want to say opposites attract, but I knew nothing about this kind of life, farm life, large animal life. And so it was, I loved learning about the horses. I loved taking care of the horses. Yeah, it was a, it was a nice time. Um, for me, I remember that being a happy time, you know?

MADISON:

You said in the video, you're like, I'm never going to be able to see a horse have a baby.

LISA:

I know. Because he wasn't going to breed. Chloe was older, and I think we had discussed he wasn't going to breed her again. So to me, I didn't see us leaving North Carolina to come to Kentucky. So he must have gotten the offer in the fall. And then we moved to Midway, Kentucky, but And that was just happenstance. He was not looking for a job. He had a friend in the horse industry that he knew reach out and say, Would you be interested in managing a horse farm in Kentucky? And of course, your dad was in the pig industry and working for a division of Smithfield Foods called Kittel's Foods, and they had that line of pork That was the lean generation fork. So he was on the genetics team. And ironically, he had to go to several rural North Carolina farms to make sure that those hogs, well, sows, stayed lean enough to breed. And so that was his job for many years. That's he, he's, that was his job when I met him and he stunk really bad.

MADISON:

I remember you saying that.

LISA:

Yeah, my brothers called him the pig man. Because when you work in the hog industry, even if you're not on the farm, like two, three days later, if your dad got really sweaty, That smell would come out of his pores. Yeah, he still was stinky. But I got used to it.

MADISON:

I remember you saying you would make him take a shower as soon as he got home before you would talk to him.

LISA:

Yeah, it was bad if you've ever smelled a hog farm. But yeah, so his dream, he, you know, he grew up, you know, your dad grew up with horses and showing horses and he was on the equine judging team at the University of Kentucky. And so when this offer came for him to manage a thoroughbred horse farm, beautiful over 800 acre farm in Midway, Kentucky breeding race horses. Yeah, it was like a, you know, an opportunity you don't pass up. And thankfully I had a career that's mobile and I said yes. And to me, I thought Kentucky was a little further, like maybe where Kansas is. I really had, I had never, the furthest I had gone was West Virginia. And I was 20. What was I then in 97? What does that make me? 27? 28.

MADISON:

29.

LISA:

29. Yep.

MADISON:

No, in 9731.

LISA:

Hmm. You're right. Because, yep, you're right. That was totally right when you do the math. So yeah, I had never really left, you know, gone on really big trips or been to, of course, the Outer Banks and I had skied, snow skied in West Virginia. I had been to Maryland. Jennifer lived in Maryland.

MADISON:

I thought you went to Colorado to ski one time, didn't you?

LISA:

Oh, yeah, that was sorry. I guess I am that I'd forgotten. My first boyfriend took a job in Idaho Falls, Idaho. And he flew me out there on my spring break in nursing school. And we did. We snow skied in Montana and Idaho. Yeah, Big Sky, Montana. I can't, I think it's something Grand Targhee, Idaho, I think is the mountain we skied on. We snowmobiled through Yellowstone. Yeah, so I had been on a trip, sorry.

MADISON:

But still, that's not like, yeah.

LISA:

Moving. Yeah, moving. Yeah. So we packed everything up into a horse trailer. He gave away his horses and sent Cedar to my sister, sent Forrest over to the nurse mare operation. I think Ellen took Chloe. And I think by the time we left, Superstar had passed. Oh no, I think maybe, I think Joyce took him back. So, yeah. That was kind of it. That was kind of the start.

MADISON:

I think that's cool too, that you bought the camera for this event and like this video, and then that's, 'cause that's why I'm doing this project is I think it's interesting that, you know, you're the one recording all of these videos and taking all these photos that we have. But yeah, like, you're not in them because you're the one that's behind the camera, so.

LISA:

Right.

MADISON:

That's really neat. I mean, I liked this video for various reasons, but I think that makes it even cooler that you bought the camera for this.

LISA:

Yeah, and it becomes the same camera that recorded your birth.

MADISON:

Yeah, that's cool to think about.

LISA:

Yeah, and I still have it. I still have that camera. But yeah, and back then it was, it was, I don't know how much it cost, but they were expensive. So it was like a, you know, something you don't just go by on a whim. And I I, you know, my family likes to take pictures and document things. And my dad had a little video camera back, way back in the 70s. And so I kind of grew up in a family that liked documenting events, which I never really saw them as history. But I'm so thankful because you've seen our home videos and You know, even way back to the 50s with my mom and my siblings when they were little. So yeah, I think I got that interest from them and enjoyed watching the old videos. And I mean, the one that still kills me Is the one the recording where my dad sent recordings from Vietnam?

MADISON:

Oh, I don't know if I've seen those or know about those.

LISA:

Yeah, we'll have to get John to play him. I'm pretty sure he played it that you girls were younger. My dad's sent, he recorded himself speaking. And sent these tapes to my mom. And. In one of them, it's John's birthday. And I don't think he sings happy birthday, but he, you know, it gets you emotional because he, you know, he says happy birthday to his son and, and you know, my dad, no one knew if they were coming home. But I think because recording and sending your voice message was important to my dad, he did that. And then my mom recorded her and the kids and sent him one, you know. I don't know how many they did, but of course, we don't hear my mom's. But we had my dad's because she had that. You know what I mean? I don't, I don't think my mom's made it back from Vietnam. Yeah. So.

MADISON:

But yeah. That's really interesting to think that. Yeah. I don't think most people would consider that technology was. able to do that. Or, you know, that's just like a very early form of, like you're saying, like sending a voice message or...

LISA:

Yeah.

MADISON:

Sending a video.

LISA:

It really was.

MADISON:

You had to do it analog. And I wonder, yeah, like if that cost a lot of money or, yeah, how they did that.

LISA:

I don't, I'll have to ask John and, and honestly, the fact that it got there, 'cause He was in such a remote location. The fact that he got it through all of the war is a miracle in itself, really.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

What a gift, though. You know, what a gift to get that. You know, John would have been 14 or 14 years old and get to hear your dad say happy birthday when you're probably very, very scared for his circumstances, you know?

MADISON:

Yeah. Yeah, I forget the age because the Vietnam War, it was like 68, right?

LISA:

No, it started 62.

MADISON:

But it also makes me think because your parents got engaged over telegram, right?

LISA:

Yes, I have that telegram.

MADISON:

So that's interesting too, this kind of through line. of them sending each other, you know, correspondence or media. Uh-huh. Oh.

LISA:

Okay.

MADISON:

How did I... To '74. The war? Yeah.

LISA:

But we got involved in '65.

MADISON:

Okay.

LISA:

And he left early. Well, your mom... had me January 66 so he'd obviously gotten her pregnant before he left. Yeah. So he left in early 65. And um.

MADISON:

So he was there when you were born?

LISA:

He he came home right before I think. I'll have to ask. You know what? I really don't know that. I think he was there. I think they gave him like, time, you know what I mean? And then he went back for a second tour. And I'll have to ask Uncle John. I think it was 70, 71. Yeah. Maybe even earlier than that, but yeah. Crazy times. My mom was so stressed out with five kids and she, I remember her telling me very clearly she would not turn the TV on because the news stations

would show video from the war zones and dead bodies. She said it was very common for, you know, like a, an NBC News correspondent to film just like All this carnage and she said you wouldn't know if that was your loved one or not. They didn't zoom in, you know, doubt they they showed faces, but she didn't want. My siblings to see. The death, you know the. The the war videos and so she wouldn't. she wouldn't turn the TV, allow them to turn the TV on, especially at dinner time when they would have the news. Back then, they only did the news like once a day at dinner time. So, yeah, I vividly remember her telling me that. And it painted a picture for me of how frightening it must have been to be a single parent. Yeah. Not, you know, not knowing And I'm and I'm sure hearing from her. Officers, wives, friends that. You know, she was very aware people weren't coming home in the death toll numbers, you know? So yeah. A lot and then and that's why my grandmother. came from England and stayed with us. And that's why she's in the picture of me turning one, because she stayed with my mom for like the whole year that my dad was in Vietnam. She or, you know, when he went back. So I guess he went back after I was born and grandma was there to help. Yeah. I don't know if you heard Auntie Jill say that she doesn't know why my mom decided to have children because she never found her to be very maternal. And I said, I agree with you.

MADISON:

Yeah, well, I was going to ask, yeah, if Nan was more emotional support than physical support.

LISA:

Yeah, she was a nan. She, I think my mom just kind of shut down and was kind of possibly non-functioning. And we called her grandma. Oh, my cousins, yeah, my cousins call her Nan, but grandma was there to take care of us. feed us, take care of us, take care of me, probably especially.

MADISON:

But her, like they weren't particularly close, like your mom and her mom, right?

LISA:

No, no. And it's funny, I don't know if my dad asked her to come or Because I, I really can't see my mom asking her to come.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

So it must have been my father. Or maybe out of, out of concern.

MADISON:

Yeah. But then it is interesting. It's like your mom and Auntie Jill, they'll both be, you know, they'll put on this front that they're like hardened or, you know, they don't care. But then it's like, they're naming their kids like the same names or like after each other.

LISA:

Right, right. Yeah. Yeah. My mom didn't show a lot of emotion except for anger. She was, she's good at that. But yeah, she, I never saw her cry. And like I told you, neither of them told me. I don't know if I've ever asked my siblings. I think I asked Julie once, but can't remember her answer. But neither parent told me they loved me. It was just something we didn't say. And I certainly never said it to my siblings. And, you know, it wasn't until my dad was declining that my coworker said, I told her that. And she said, Oh my gosh, Lisa, you have to tell your father you love him. And I said, I really don't think I can without crying. It just felt like such an emotional thing to say. And she said, You have to say it. You just, even if he doesn't say it back, you got to say it. So I did. He was very sick and I was, he didn't make it to the bathroom. And I was cleaning up his vomit. And it was after chemo. And he was very embarrassed. He came out of the bathroom. And he went and sat in his chair. And. At this point, they sat in separate rooms. My mom was in the living room and he was in. We called it a day room, but it was a den. And. I was cleaning him up a little bit. He still had a little bit on his pants. And the chair and. He said something to the effect of. I'm sorry you have to do this. And I joked because, you know, it's easier to joke than to be serious. And I said, Oh, well, you pick you paid good money for this. You sent me to nursing school and made a big joke and, and so I was cleaning up. I remember I wasn't looking at him. I was looking down, so I must have been cleaning the floor. And I said, You know I love you, Dad, right? And he said, I know, honey. And then I quickly just, you know, picked up everything, all the towels and things, and I... Took them out into the garage and I stepped. There's a door out of the garage. I remember stepping out. And just basically crying my eyes out on the side of the house. It felt good to say it. But I kind of wanted him to say it back. But I know he did. I've had people ask me, How do you know they did? And I said, Well, they took care of me, you know? They had a way for the ball head. They provided, you know, all the basics. And my mom was a thoughtful gift giver. They showed love in different ways. You know, I'd show up at my dad's work. He'd give me \$20 for gas. He always gave me, you know, my siblings think I was the favorite because I was the baby, but. And maybe I was. I didn't feel that way. I didn't feel like I got anything extra. But I loved him so much. He was. He was everything to me. He and he was such a good man. I wish you had met him. He was. Everybody thought so highly of him. He was. Very. Held in very high regard by everyone who knew him. Just a upstanding citizen. Always did the right thing. Well, except, except for spanking us, but that was like the norm back then. And, and I mean, he, he grew up so poor that Yeah, to get where he was was really remarkable. And I just feel like he didn't have a very happy life. Other than us, other than he very much loved his kids and was very proud of us. I mean, You know, you've seen the picture in the house. One of my favorite pictures is him kissing me on my graduation day.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

And that smiling one of him at, they call it a pinning ceremony when I got my nurse's pin. It's kind of like your baccalaureate for high school. And that smile on his face. I think Julie got that shot. Mm-hmm. And then that month that I graduated, he was diagnosed with lung cancer.

MADISON:

Mm-hmm. How, or like, what was the timeline that day that you told him you loved him? Like, was he in hospice at that point or?

LISA:

He never would agree to Hospice.

MADISON:

But basically he was on home Hospice.

LISA:

Yeah, I we we didn't. I was his home health nurse. So. He didn't. Need much until the very end and. That's when. You know, Madison, I'm going to say a couple weeks a month. After I said that, I was doing some deep, deep lung suctioning and his secretions were so thick that he was turning cyanotic when I was suctioning him, like his nail beds would go glue and his lips would go glue. And I finally was like, you know, he was just gurgling and I, I called my brother David. To come. And we talked outside and I said. I can't do it anymore. I think he needs to go to the hospital. And I said, I don't think she's going to. Agree. And because my dad did not want to die at the hospital, he wanted to die at home. And so David went in. and then into the living room and I went in and we did have a home health nurse we could call for emergencies. And so she my mom agreed to call the home health nurse and she came out and she told my mom that he needed to go to the hospital. And to get, they needed to give him, you know, Lasix, diuretics and pull some of that fluid, or he was just going to drown in his own secretions. And so the ambulance came and I wanted, I, his blood pressure was low. I wanted to ride in the ambulance and the ambulance guy, like, treated me like I was stupid. bit and said. You know, ma'am. Not a good idea. You know if he codes because they were freaked out that my dad was a full code. They couldn't believe that he wasn't on Hospice and that he was a do not resuscitate. But my dad, his thought process was he was a Colonel in the army. He wasn't going to give up. And to him that was giving up and. So I said, I'm a nurse. I'm aware. I'm fully aware because, you know, the EMT said, you know, if we start chest compressions, he's so frail, we might crack a rib, you know, he might not make it, you know, blah, blah, blah. And I said, I'm I was obsessed with my dad not dying alone without one, you know, someone with him family and I said, I know that. So

I rode. They let me on the ambulance. I get to the hospital before everyone else. So I I'm the one giving like the history. And the ER was like. He's a full code. And I said, yes, he's a full code. And they they were freaking out. So they send us up to the oncology floor. Now it's like. middle of the night one two in the morning and the floor nurses call his oncologist and they tell me I need to go to the nurse's station to speak to the oncologist on call and it wasn't my dad's regular uh Physician, but it was his partner and he proceeds to chew me out. Over the phone that we are being unrealistic as a family that he's going to die. It is imminent. He's going to die. And we're holding on to it, you know. An unrealistic hope. La la la. I said it is not my choice. My my father is here and he's alert. You can ask him. And I said, and my mother is his power of attorney. So you're going to have to speak to one of them. But I'm just telling you, these are his wishes and he's still alive. And that ***** him off, man. He was so mad one that he got woken up. And then the very next morning. He was there at the hospital. And he called my mother. From. You know, after he saw my dad. And I don't know what their conversation was, Madison, but my mother made my mother made him a do not resuscitate. And he lived that was Sunday or like. Early Monday morning and. His birthday was the following Sunday. He was. He always said he wanted to live. He wanted to get to 65. He was diagnosed at 60. And they gave him 18 months to live. And he is 64, gonna turn 65 and at 5. something a.m. on his 65th birthday. He passed away. Couldn't, couldn't even make it up. John, John had, we celebrated his birthday the day before because it was Saturday. John made a pecan pie. He brought it to the hospital. Everybody came to the hospital. We all sang him happy birthday. He was kind of in and out because of course they were given a morphine. But I saw his pulse rate go up and he got really diaphoretic, really sweaty. So I knew he could hear us. And so after we sang happy birthday, I said, hey everybody, you know, why don't you? There was a waiting room at the end of the hall. I said, hey, why don't. There were conversations going on. I said, hey, why don't. Why don't some of you go down to the end of the hall? And dad, dad's little worked up. And so like little Johnny and them went down the hallway and I got dad a little more comfortable. I got a washcloth for his forehead and then everybody left and Jennifer had come into town and Julie, they lived out, out of, out, you know, Jennifer up in Pennsylvania and Julie was in vet school, but they were there. And David and I and Keith had been staying the night. So somebody was always there with that during the day, at night. So Jennifer and Julie asked, could they stay Saturday night to give me and David a break? And I said, yeah, you know, I don't care who's there, really. I just want somebody there. And I wasn't being bossy, but. And little Johnny asked if he could stay. He really. He adored my dad. So. Jennifer and I had given him a bath Saturday morning and he had. a really sustained period of apnea. I thought he was going to pass Saturday. He didn't. So we went home, Keith and I, and they called me. And I, to this day, do not regret that. I just, I'm, and I'm actually kind of happy. Maybe dad was holding on for them, you know?

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

Maybe he was holding on till Julie got there.

MADISON:

Yeah. I think that is, yeah.

LISA:

Julie was holding one hand, Jennifer was holding the other, and little Johnny was holding on to his feet. And then we got dressed, we lived. right down the road from the hospital not even maybe 20 minutes and David was 40 across the river and um I called Father Carey the Catholic priest who had married us I think I've told you the story he came uh September Um, because my dad died September 18th. Um. And. He was wearing his. He was a Franciscan priest. And he was wearing his brown shroud with his rope belt and his Birkenstock sandals. And. He it's so early in the morning. I was standing outside the room because the nurses, the nurses were in there taking some of the equipment and things, you know what I mean? Getting him his body ready. And here comes Father Carrie. He looked like the Grim Reaper coming down the hallway. Like these are really, really long hallways and with his hood, you know, and everything and I know those nurses were like, what is going on? Their faces were kind of shocked, but, you know, it's just his, just his attire for his career. And I was, oh my God, I'm so thankful. I felt like in a way that was like divine intervention that he married us and in January, and this is September, same year. And he was able to be there for us at this two pivotal moments in our life. My father really, really liked him because he was an Air Force priest. And then my sister Jennifer had gone to get my mother. And Not too long after. I was, you know. With Father Carrie and he was comforting me and. Keith and my Julie. My mom showed up and that. I'll never forget. How grateful my mom was. That. A priest was there. And it was just really weird because she had such a messed up relationship with the Catholic Church. And but I think when you're raised so traditional, to know that Father Terry gave my dad his last rites was so comforting. I mean, I've never seen her So grateful to anybody in my life. And. I think that really did give her a lot of peace. That. That sacrament, even though my dad wasn't Catholic. And she also mentioned because he was military. Kind of checked all the boxes, you know. Mm-hmm. And we were all in the room. We all went into the room. I can't tell you what he said. It was beautiful. He did the sign of the cross on his forehead. It was just really, if I, you know, if we hadn't gotten married, I would have never developed a relationship with him and He's just such a kind priest and was perfect. I've told a lot of people it was, if you're ever gonna be with someone who passed away, my dad passed away so peacefully. And he wouldn't have at home. Like he was struggling to breathe at home. So essentially, the last five days or so, they did put him on hospice. You know, I'm sure they were giving him a large amount of morphine to make him comfortable. And it was, it was the right thing to do. I thought for many months of writing a scathing letter to the oncology group and letting Dr. Madden's partner know how uncompassionate he was at a critical time in our family's grief. What horrible bedside manner he had. And you know, letting them know as a nurse in the medical profession. He was. You know, crap. To me, that was like to put me through that phone

call. And make me feel guilty. Like, like I couldn't see the writing on the wall when it wasn't even my decision to make. I just happened to be the family reporter that rode in the ambulance. Oh, but. Thankfully, whoever, I mean, I'm sure I told Keith and I'm sure I told David and they probably both told me just to calm, you know, think about it.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

You know, give it some time, see how you feel. And then, you know, I decided I wouldn't write it, but I did feel like he was an ***** and he should not be in the profession he is in. Because there was no compassion there. Yeah, and I hope. I hope other people didn't have to go through that with him because. I yeah, I think. I think what you want to do and the gift that is to be a chaplain or to help people transition. Is such a gift I. I could not do it. I'm just. Way too emotional and. I think I would be. very unhelpful. I think I would probably cry more than the family would want me to, and I would probably say the wrong thing.

MADISON:

I think those are natural, normal fears, though. I don't know. We'll see. Maybe I'll cry too much. But I also think people I don't know, that was like when I talked with one of my professors here and told her, you know, everything. Dad dying, like she started crying and I feel like that was actually, you know, I felt more like seen or appreciated in that conversation than a lot of the other conversations I've been having.

LISA:

Yeah, I get that. I, uh, we were putting Penny down. And of course it was the vet. I think I told you it was the vet who. Was dad's friend. Sort of friends like he worked with her husband who was an equine vet. And then he that's when Penny was having all of that incontinence and he thought it was a UTI. So. Doctor Wells's husband said, why don't you take her into my wife? She's at Scott County Animal Hospital. And so he took, Dad took Penny to Christine and that's when she got diagnosed with the bladder stones. Yeah. But Dad didn't have the money. He wasn't going to pay, he wasn't going to get the surgery, so. Reese and I said we would pay. It was expensive. It was almost. It was like 6000 something dollars. So we paid and we did the follow up. Like we brought her here. Took care of her, took her back for her follow up appointment. So we knew Christine. And then. When we switched from Buffalo Trace vet out here to Eckert. We were there, I don't know, not even a year. And they announced they were getting a new vet and her name was Christine Wells. And I said, Oh my God, I said, we know Christine. And we had gone out there with Finley because they did acupuncture. And they were just a younger group that kind of up on the literature of new things to try for Finley. So, remember Christine was the one, she was the vet when we had Angel. She thought Angel was a boy. Or a girl. Yeah, a girl.

That's right. And then we gave her a hard time after that. And then I gave her back the stones because I had asked for the bladder stones. And we had those for a long time, you remember? So then When she came to my vet practice, I said, oh my gosh, let me give you the stones because that way if you need to show a client or your kids want to take them in for show and tell or something. And so they have the stones at the vet. And so when we took Penny in that last day, it was with Christine and she's the one who put her down. And the reason I'm telling you this is she started crying.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

And she said, I feel like it's a full, she says, I've met, I never met a dog who was tougher than her. And, you know, she says, I'm so glad, you know, I was here. You know, kind of a full circle moment. And she said, you did everything you could for her. And then she was crying and And she she. They put him into a little box that looks like a coffin. And. She said to the technician was going to pick her up and she said no. She said I wanna. I wanna do it with dignity. Not that the technician wouldn't have done it with dignity, but. Christine wanted to lift Penny into the box. So, yeah, so the reason I'm saying this is it did feel good that she cried with us.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

Because it's okay to cry. You know, it's okay to show how much you feel.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

But I felt horrible because It was the day before Easter and her kids were there. They brought in, an emergency came in while we were there. Oh, it was, that was a really stressful day for her too. Oh my gosh, I'm sorry, I'm like, big crybaby today.

MADISON:

Don't apologize. I think, well, it's like a, yeah, for me, it's an emotional video. And then I think there are obvious connections to things in both of our lives that are also emotional. So it's normal, I think. Yeah.

LISA:

Yeah. Yeah, I think I was really excited to see that birth because it was all new to me. A lot of similarities to medicine. Especially childbirth, so.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

I was.

MADISON:

Yeah, it is interesting to me how similar it seems like they are and that, you know, dad and then kind of all the men on the CISL side, you know, they just know that very well. So.

LISA:

Yes. Yeah.

MADISON:

Or, you know, they know that better than. Probably most vets or, you know, vet students and then.

LISA:

Right.

MADISON:

Thinking, yeah, just they'd probably know a lot about human birth too, but they just.

LISA:

Oh yeah, sure. Your dad did. I mean, I didn't have to tell him anything, but he was so funny and. You know, when he passed out, when we went to see Ellen after she had a Carly. He passed out. in the room because of just seeing the blood, like her, her changing pads, you know, the bloody, uh, sanitary pads and everything and... Slinky, get out of there. Slinky. He's teaching this puppy to go where the cats poop. Um, come on, Pippa. But yeah, and then of course he passed out with you and Dirk, I wouldn't even let him like he just videoed in from a chair, I think.

MADISON:

Yeah. Well, I was thinking about that in the video because you can see blood on the ground and it's like, yeah.

LISA:

He can do anything. He can do anything to a horse. Madison at Waterford, one day a mare went down. They call it a red bag. She was delivering the placenta first, which is what? Would have happened with Anne Marie with me. And she went down in the field. The bag was first. They had to do an emergency seat like Kevin did the sea set like he he sliced her open. And then the vet got there. And the soul lived. Of course, the mayor didn't, but. She was hemorrhaging, you know, she was dying anyways. But he came home that day and you would have thought somebody threw a bucket of blood on him. He was bloody from his neck down. I've never seen anything like it. We just threw his clothes away. But he he said he can do anything to an animal. Like he castrates, you know, they castrate them, the cattle, he can do anything, but he can't see. And he can see his own blood sometimes, not like, giving blood. He could never do that. But he can't see other people's blood, like your blood, my blood.

MADISON:

But I'm kind of, I guess I thought, well, maybe we were... Because it's like, usually I pass out with my blood, right? But it's, I think I'm fairly okay with other people's.

LISA:

He did giving blood, like if he ever had to give blood for like a lab test, he passed out like you. But what I mean, his blood, like once he got a really bad cut at work while he was working or at the UK farm when he was in college and he didn't pass out with that. But it was mostly thinking about it and also the smells, like seeing it, smelling it, those kinds of things. So, um, like when you cut your ankle?

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

I wasn't even sure because I was in the back with you because you were getting shocky and he was driving, but I was like, I don't even know if this is a good scenario. Because he, I just kept telling him, don't look, you know, don't, don't look back. But yeah, you're starting to get nauseous and you're very pale. So yeah, that was, in hindsight, probably not the smartest thing. I asked Carrie Thomas to watch Brooke. I can't remember, I guess. Yeah, we'd had Anne Marie, so I guess you had to watch Anne Marie too.

MADISON:

Yeah.

LISA:

By then. Hey, give me that. Jesus Christ. Get out of here. She's eating. She found a walnut, which they're like, you know what I mean? Yeah. Come on out of here. How does she even find

that? She's so tiny though. She can get into little, little holes. You're gonna make yourself sick and die. Poisonous. All right, come on, guys. All right, honey. I won't keep you anymore. I know you've got to do school work.

MADISON:

Okay, well, thank you.

LISA:

You're welcome.

MADISON:

Are you okay with me keeping the recording of all the things we talked about?

LISA:

Oh, yes. Yes, of course.

MADISON:

Okay. What was that experience like for you? Quickly.

LISA:

The foaling.

MADISON:

Or like, what? I guess I'm just curious to hear, 'cause I haven't done it, like, trying to narrate, you know, a video from...

LISA:

Oh, that experience.

MADISON:

...Almost 30 years ago, you know, that you haven't seen in a while.

LISA:

Yeah.

MADISON:

With your dead ex-husband. Like...

LISA:

Yeah. Um... It was good. It was good memories. Yeah. I didn't feel uncomfortable. Um... it reminded me of happier times. So it was good, you know.

MADISON:

Yeah, but it didn't seem like it was difficult for you, like, to fill in the space or it seemed like you heard a lot of the details.

LISA:

Yeah, no, not of that time. That was so early in our relationship that, um, I remember that time, like, fondly, you know? And I was learning so much. I liked that. I liked learning about his life and his horses and, you know, just being on a farm. It was therapy for me, really. I enjoyed leaving the city and going there for the weekend when we were dating, and then, of course, when we decided to move in together, it just made sense for me to move there. So yeah, it wasn't difficult at all, really.

MADISON:

Okay. Well, thank you for doing that.

LISA:

You're welcome.

MADISON:

I hope you enjoy the rest of your Sunday. Maybe take it easy since it was emotional at times.

LISA:

Yeah, I've had an easy weekend. Anne Marie, we just, we hung out at home yesterday and she gets off work at six. So it'll be another, another easy night.

MADISON:

Okay.

LISA:

All right, honey. Well, thanks for calling. Let me know if you have any other questions. Okay. All right. Bye. I love you. I love you too. Okay. Bye.

MADISON:

Bye.